

BuddyBoard

Real-Time Pool Safety Tracking for Camp

Project Overview · Prepared June 2026 · Confidential

What Is BuddyBoard?

BuddyBoard is a web-based safety system that gives camp pool counselors a live, shared view of every camper currently in the water. When two kids enter the pool together, a counselor registers them as a **buddy pair**. That pair appears instantly on every device at that pool — so all counselors always know exactly who is in the water, in real time.

When kids leave the pool, their pair is removed. When it's time for a **buddy call**, counselors open a clean, easy-to-read screen and call off every pair by name. If everyone answers, the pool is safe.

Core purpose: Every counselor at every pool can always see — in real time — exactly which camper pairs are currently in the water, so no child goes unaccounted for.

Who Uses It

Role	Who They Are	What They Do in BuddyBoard
Pool Counselor	Staff at the poolside, managing kids checking in and out	Start a pool session, register buddy pairs, view the live buddy board, run buddy calls, remove pairs when kids leave
Admin	Camp leadership or office staff who manage the system	Upload and maintain the camper roster, manage counselor accounts, configure the pool list

Key Features

FAST BUDDY CHECK-IN

- Counselor enters two campers to form a pair
- Look up by **camper code** (fastest — single field)
- Or look up by **name typeahead** (start typing, pick from list)
- Pair appears on all devices at that pool instantly

LIVE BUDDY BOARD

- All current pairs shown in a scrollable list
- Live swimmer count: "12 swimmers — 6 pairs"
- Updates in real time as counselors add or remove pairs
- Clear status when disconnected — never silently stale

BUDDY CALL SCREEN

- Full-screen, high-contrast view for outdoor use
- Large text and touch targets for iPad / poolside conditions
- Scrollable ordered list of all active pairs
- Designed for bright sunlight readability

CAMPER ROSTER MANAGEMENT

- Bulk import via Excel spreadsheet upload
- Add, edit, or remove individual campers at any time
- Each camper has a staff-assigned code for fast check-in
- Search and filter the full roster by name or code

POOL & SESSION MANAGEMENT

- Configurable pool list (defaults to 3 pools)
- Counselors start and close sessions per pool
- Confirmation required before closing with active pairs
- Session history is archived — records are never deleted

USER & ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT

- Counselors log in with username and password
- Sessions persist across browser restarts
- Admins add and remove staff accounts
- Admins reset passwords directly — no email flow needed

Safety Design Decisions

Safety-critical design: Several features are deliberately designed around the consequence of getting them wrong — a child unaccounted for in a pool.

Real-Time Across All Devices

When any counselor at Pool 2 registers or removes a pair, every other device connected to Pool 2 updates within seconds — no page refresh, no manual sync. Multiple counselors can check kids in simultaneously without stepping on each other.

Connection Status Always Visible

If a tablet loses its connection to the system, a prominent banner immediately alerts the counselor: "*Disconnected — data may be stale.*" A board that silently stops updating is more dangerous than one that clearly shows it has a problem.

Remove Requires Server Confirmation

When a counselor removes a buddy pair, the pair does not disappear from the screen until the server confirms the removal. This prevents a pair from vanishing from the board while the children are still in the water due to a network hiccup.

Duplicate Detection

The system prevents the same camper from being registered in two pairs at the same time — even if two counselors attempt to add them simultaneously. The database enforces this rule; it cannot be bypassed by a fast enough click.

Devices & Access

BuddyBoard is a web application — no installation required. Open a browser and log in.

PRIMARY

iPad & Laptop

Full experience — all features, optimized layout for poolside use

SECONDARY

iPhone

All features accessible — compact layout, best-effort on smaller screen

HOSTING

Web (Cloud)

Hosted online — accessible from any device on the camp network or internet

Multi-Pool Support

Each pool has its own independent buddy board. Counselors at Pool 1 see only Pool 1's pairs; counselors at Pool 2 see only Pool 2's pairs. Multiple counselors can manage the same pool simultaneously — two or three people checking kids in at once, all seeing each other's updates live.

When a camper switches pools, they are removed from their current pool's board by that counselor, and re-registered as a new pair when they arrive at the next pool. Each pool's board stays independent and clean.